# PRE-BIBLE PITCH SHEET

Airdate: **Wednesday, Nov 25, 2026** (F2, tapes Fri Nov 20), the day before Thanksgiving · **One story** (producer, 11/11; Ryan's angle): a longer A, parking lot scams, Costco first, other stores to build it out · Prepared Wed, Nov 11, 2026 · Audience 55+.

## THE SHORTLIST — RANKED

| # | Story | Lead title | Clip (with link) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **THE COSTCO PARKING LOT SCAMS: THEY STRIKE WHILE YOU LOAD THE CAR** | The Costco Parking Lot TRAP — They STEAL EVERYTHING While You Load! | NBC Bay Area, Vallejo Costco robbery on camera · FOX 13 Seattle, "blessing" jewelry thefts · TikTok @jasnahooke, Costco car tampering, 447K+ (per Motor1) |

**HOW THIS WAS BUILT:** the producer set the theme (Ryan's pitch: Costco first, Jeff as Costco's biggest fan). I searched every way shoppers get hit in store lots, 2024 to Nov 2026: jewelry swaps, fake gold, purse grabs, car tampering, trackers, fake tickets, pump asks. I kept only cases with a dated, named source and checked them against our coverage and the dead list. Six angles made the show; the stories-inside-the-story page has all of them, with what's in and what's out.

**SLATE FIT:** Fills the show. Four of the six angles happened at a Costco. Every victim we lead with is our viewer (86, 82, 75, 93, 71). The first three beats carry real losses (an heirloom medallion; $1,500 in gift cards within 30 minutes; $15,800 in fake gold). The peg is the busiest shopping weekend of the year, and the fix list is something every viewer can use Friday morning. **Three flags for the room:** (1) "Parking lot panhandling hustles" is on our dead list, so the fake-gold beat is framed as organized fraud with a stakeout and guilty pleas, never as people asking for money. (2) Jeff's approved donation tap-to-pay story says that scam is "spreading to the busiest parking lots"; it stays out unless it airs first, then it's a callback. (3) **Clip heat is unconfirmed:** YouTube blocked every view count, and the two big TikTok numbers come from Motor1, not TikTok.

# 1. THE COSTCO PARKING LOT SCAMS: THEY STRIKE WHILE YOU LOAD THE CAR

**Status:** READY (needs a clip check) · **Score:** 11/14 (Fear 2, Heat 1, Track record 1, Breadth 2, Peg 2, Newness 1, Producibility 2) · **Lead test:** 2 of 3

### POTENTIAL PACKAGING

- The Costco Parking Lot TRAP — They STEAL EVERYTHING While You Load!
- If a Stranger Does THIS in the Costco Parking Lot — WALK AWAY!
- Costco Shoppers Are Being TARGETED — Do THIS Before You Load Your Car

**Built on:** "The New DELIVERY TRAP — They Can STEAL EVERYTHING!" (668K); our Costco titles (Kirkland 2.3M). "3 Costco SCAMS" did 156K: lead on the threat, not a count.

### THE PITCH

The riskiest minute of a Costco run is in the lot: arms full, purse in the cart. Police say organized crews wait for it, with a "gift" necklace that swaps out your gold, a purse grab while you load, a car that suddenly won't start. Costco's fraud page warns about emails, not the lot. Jeff, Costco's biggest fan, goes after the bad guys before Black Friday.

### CASES

- **Mettawa, IL Costco (March 2026).** "Real gold" for airport and gas money; a shopper paid **$15,800** for fakes. Police staked out the lot; two men pleaded guilty. *Wealth of Geeks via Yahoo*, *Aug 2, 2026.* CHECK: primary source.
- **San Jose Costco (Aug 2026).** Two women put a "gift" necklace on an **86-year-old** loading groceries and took his 18K heirloom medallion; a second car blocked the couple in. *NBC Bay Area*, *Aug 23.*
- **Renton, WA Walmart (Feb 2026).** A 71-year-old's necklace held his brother's Tuskegee Airman ring. Detectives got it back; four charged. *FOX 13 Seattle*, *Feb 13.* LEGAL: not-guilty pleas.
- **Portland Costco (May 2024).** Three men lifted a **93-year-old's** wallet; **$1,500** in gift cards bought within 30 minutes. *KOIN*.
- **Lehi, UT Costco (June 2026).** A Corolla wouldn't start; two "helpers" pulled a fuse and asked $200. *Motor1*. CHECK: police details are her account.

> **CLIP** — NBC Bay Area, Vallejo Costco (purse robbery on a car camera, Aug 2025) · KATU, Portland 93-year-old · FOX 13 Seattle "blessing" thefts · TikTok @jasnahooke, 447K+ (per Motor1)
> *Not watched — no timecode, no outcue. No view count confirmed (YouTube bot wall). TikToks are manual pulls.*

### COVERAGE CHECK

Never a lot segment. Close: "$20 distraction" (Jul 29), QR meters (May 27), the old "3 Costco SCAMS" (contents unknown). Checked transcripts, titles, dead list, Drive to 11/11.

### FOOTAGE WE NEED

- **The get:** the Vallejo Costco car-camera robbery; then FOX 13's surveillance and bodycam, KATU (Portland), the @jasnahooke TikTok. **Demo:** Jim Stickley hides a tracker on a car and Jeff's phone alerts.

### THE PAYOFF

- **Purse in the car first, then lock the doors while you load the trunk** (King County Sheriff; Portland PD).
- Never let a stranger put anything on you (Sacramento Sheriff). Car "won't start"? Stay in, locked, call police (Culpeper Sheriff). Turn on tracker alerts *(demo)*.

## THE STORIES INSIDE THE STORY

Each angle, with what it adds and whether it's in the show. The outline puts them in this order. Jeff's 11/04 notes: open on the biggest real result, give every case its own tell, and hold the step-by-step fix for the payoff.

### 1. THE "GIFT" THAT TAKES YOUR GOLD — San Jose Costco (IN, the open)

Two women, religious small talk, a "gift" necklace around an 86-year-old's neck while he loads groceries with his 75-year-old wife. His heirloom medallion (from the priest who married them) is gone, a fake left behind, and a second car with men blocks them in. **Adds:** a Costco, our viewer, a crew, and a fear beat in one case. **Tell:** a stranger who wants to put something on you. Clip: none confirmed on NBC Bay Area's page (check by hand); Salinas Costco backup, KION.

### 2. THEY GOT HIM BACK HIS BROTHER'S RING — Renton, WA (IN: the result)

The "blessing" crew took a 71-year-old's necklace holding his brother's Tuskegee Airman ring. Bellevue detectives recovered it; three arrested and a fourth charged (not-guilty pleas). Surveillance and bodycam exist. **Adds:** Jeff's "show a real result early," and proof it's organized (Sacramento's sheriff says the same at Costco, Sam's Club, Walmart, Lowe's and Home Depot, targets mostly 50 to 70-plus, July 2026). Clips: FOX 13 arrests, FOX 13 ring returned. Taste: police name a nationality; we say "an organized group."

### 3. YOUR PURSE IS GONE, AND YOUR CARDS ARE DRAINED IN MINUTES (IN)

Vallejo Costco: a car camera catches a woman knocked down from behind while loading and her purse taken (Aug 2025, two minors arrested). Portland Costco: a 93-year-old's wallet lifted; $1,500 in gift cards before he got home (May 2024). Clarksville Sam's Club: an 82-year-old's purse snatched as she returned her cart (Jan 2026). Boynton Beach: police say two women in wigs and medical masks stole from older shoppers for months, then bought gift cards (Mar 2026). **Adds:** the caught-on-camera moment and the extended threat (your cards, within minutes). **Tell:** "excuse me, which way to...?" while your purse sits in the cart.

### 4. "REAL GOLD" FOR GAS MONEY — Mettawa, IL Costco, $15,800 (IN, framed as fraud)

A man in the Costco lot needed money "to get to the airport"; the next day he sold the shopper "$16,000" of jewelry for $15,800. Fake. Police staked out the lot, the SUV hit an undercover car, two men pleaded guilty and got probation. Same script in Kauai (Walmart, Feb 2025), Eugene (Mar 2026), Hillsboro (Lowe's, Aug 2025). **Adds:** the biggest dollar loss and a sting. **Tell:** a hard-luck story plus "real gold," cash only. Clip: KREM (pawn shop real-or-fake test), KOAA. **DEAD-LIST CAUTION:** keep it on the loss and the stakeout; no confrontation compilations, and many bodycam uploads carry a slur in the title. Don't use those.

### 5. YOUR CAR WON'T START, AND THE "HELPERS" ARE RIGHT THERE — Lehi, UT Costco (IN)

Her Corolla dies after shopping; two men offer a jump, pull a fuse, ask $200, then pour water on the engine when she says no. She says police saw them on Costco's lot footage circling and going under the car. TikTok 447K+ (per Motor1). Flat-tire version: Culpeper, VA Sheriff (Aug 2025), "a good Samaritan" points out the flat while a partner takes the purse; Vinnie Penn's retelling, 1.1M+ per Motor1 (a Starbucks, not a store lot). **Adds:** a new move, and the show's biggest reported clip numbers. **Tell:** the trouble starts while you're inside, and the help is already waiting.

### 6. A TRACKER ON YOUR CAR — Auburn, AL (IN: the stop-and-check payoff)

Her iPhone said a tracker was moving with her; the first ping was at Sam's Club, and she believes it went on at a Walmart. A magnetic GPS unit under the car (WTVM, Sept 2025). Also Fort Wayne (zip-tied under the bumper, Aug 2025) and Sulphur, LA (Nov 2025). **Adds:** the "check it right now" moment: Stickley hides one, both phones alert. Motive unknown: say "someone," and keep it off home burglary (11/11). An older Rossen Reports piece covered AirTags on cars (KCRA); the demo makes it new.

**7. QUICK HITS (JEFF LINES)**

The Costco pump ask: "can you scan your membership for me?" (Motley Fool, 2024; anecdotal). Fake parking tickets on windshields at a mall with no meters (Hurst, TX PD, Apr 2025); its QR code is a callback to May 27. **Myth buster:** the "paper on your back window" carjacking warning is a hoax that has circulated since about 2004.

**8. OUT OR CALLBACK ONLY**

Tap-to-pay "donation" collectors (Jeff's approved standalone). The $20-on-the-floor distraction (Jul 29). Bank-lot cash handoffs (Jul 29). Follow-home robberies (home framing; 11/11). "You hit my car" (no 2025–26 U.S. case). Costco pump skimmers (none found in 2025–26). Concrete-filled "speakers" (creator recap, no primary source).

# RESEARCH SOURCES & VERIFICATION FLAGS

### READ THIS FIRST

- **I cannot watch video.** Clips are described from titles, pages and articles only. No timecodes or outcues here.
- **No view count is confirmed.** YouTube blocked watch pages; titles and channels were confirmed through YouTube's oEmbed. TikTok refuses requests from here. The 447K and 1.1M figures are Motor1's reporting of TikTok numbers.
- **What our old "3 Costco SCAMS — EXPOSED LIVE!" covered is unknown** (SKagNLR5x6M, 156K). Someone needs to watch it before the outline, so we don't repeat a case.
- Full case file: research_parking.md.

### STORY 1 — THE COSTCO PARKING LOT SCAMS

**Confirmed:**

- San Jose, Costco at Almaden Plaza: two women approached an elderly couple loading groceries, used religious talk, and put a "gift" necklace on the husband; his 18-karat gold medallion was taken and a fake chain left; a second car with at least two men blocked the couple's car. Husband 86, wife 75. Police confirmed arrests the following Monday (NBC Bay Area, Aug 23–24, 2026).
- Bellevue PD "blessing" thefts: Rickey Foreman, 71, at a Renton Walmart: "was clamping it around my neck"; the necklace held three rings, one his brother's, a Tuskegee Airman; recovered. Three arrested, a fourth charged; not-guilty pleas. In a linked Lynnwood H-Mart attempt a woman was knocked down and broke a vertebra (FOX 13 Seattle, Feb 13, 2026).
- Sacramento County Sheriff: jewelry distraction thefts at or near Costco, Sam's Club, Walmart, Lowe's, Home Depot and two Asian markets; targets mostly 50 to 70-plus; some victims followed home; "never allow strangers to place jewelry, scarves or other items around their necks" (Folsom Times, Jul 27, 2026).
- Vallejo Costco: a camera on a nearby car caught a woman knocked down from behind while loading and her purse taken; two minors arrested, tied to a second robbery an hour later (NBC Bay Area, Aug 21, 2025).
- Portland: three men followed a 93-year-old out of Costco and took his wallet; about $1,500 in gift cards at Fred Meyer before he got home; Det. Jordan Zaitz: "They're pretty organized"; attempts at Costcos in Portland, Tigard, Kirkland, Puyallup, Tukwila and Lynnwood (KOIN, May 24, 2024).
- Clarksville, TN Sam's Club, Jan 8, 2026: an 82-year-old's purse snatched as she returned her cart; three arrested (Clarksville Now, Jan 15, 2026).
- Boynton Beach, FL: police say two women in disguises stole wallets from older shoppers, then bought $100 gift cards; charges include "scheme to defraud a person over 65" (CBS12, Mar 12, 2026).
- Gold-for-gas cases: Kauai PD, Walmart lot, Feb 2025, arrest (county press release); Eugene PD, three victims in two weeks (KLCC, Mar 3, 2026); Hillsboro PD, Lowe's lot, Aug 2025, arrest (KPTV); West Shore RCMP, two arrested Mar 7, 2026.
- Auburn, AL: an iPhone alert; first ping at Sam's Club; a magnetic GPS tracker with audio under the car (WTVM, Sept 15, 2025).
- Costco's "Preventing Fraud" page (published 03/16/2026) lists six online and phone scams and nothing about the lot.
- Tracker alert paths: iPhone, Settings > Notifications > Tracking Notifications (plus Bluetooth and Location Services on), and Find My > Items > Unknown Items Detected with You (Apple Support); Android, Settings > Safety & emergency > Unknown tracker alerts > Scan now (Google Support).
- Boone County, WV Sheriff, Nov 1, 2026: trunk purchases before you arrive, park in busy, lit spots, lock every time (WTAP).

**Sources:** NBC Bay Area, San Jose Costco · NBC Bay Area, San Jose arrests · FOX 13 Seattle, blessing thefts · Folsom Times, Sacramento Sheriff · Yahoo, Chino · Yahoo, Edmonds WinCo · NCTV17, Naperville · Yahoo, Mettawa $15,800 · Kauai PD · KLCC, Eugene · KPTV, Hillsboro · RCMP West Shore · NBC Bay Area, Vallejo · KOIN, Portland · Clarksville Now · CBS12, Boynton Beach · Motor1, Lehi Costco · Yahoo, American Fork PD · Fredericksburg Free Press, Culpeper · Motor1, Vinnie Penn · WTVM, Auburn · 21Alive, Fort Wayne · KPLC, Sulphur · CBS Texas, Hurst fake ticket · Costco, Preventing Fraud · WTAP, Boone County · KIRO 7, King County 2019 · ValuePenguin

**NEEDS VERIFICATION:**

- **The biggest number on the page rests on one secondary source.** Mettawa's $15,800 and the guilty pleas come from Wealth of Geeks on Yahoo, crediting the Lake and McHenry County Scanner. I couldn't find the Scanner post or a court record. Confirm with the Lake County State's Attorney, or don't use the number.
- **San Jose:** the arrests NBC reported Aug 26 aren't tied to the Costco couple in the article. Say "police confirmed arrests" only as NBC's Aug 23 story does.
- **Lehi:** "police saw them on Costco's footage" is the victim's account, relayed by Motor1. Confirm with Lehi or American Fork PD, or say "she says."
- **The tease line "crews are watching the Costco lot" is the inference to watch.** Police say organized groups target big-box lots (Sacramento, Portland, Bellevue). Don't say Costco is a special target or that its lots are less safe. LEGAL: Costco is the hero's store, not the villain. Ask Costco for comment ("we reached out").
- **The stat:** "about 1 in 10 property crimes happen in a parking lot or garage" is ValuePenguin's (an insurance-comparison site) analysis of 2020 FBI data. Name it that way, or drop it.
- Dates on air: Portland is May 2024; Vallejo Aug 2025; the King County "60 Costco purse thefts" figure is 2019 (background only).
- Ethnicity: police and FOX 13's headline name a nationality for the Bellevue group. We don't. "Accused," "an organized group."
- The TikTok counts (447K Lehi, 1.1M Penn) are Motor1's, not seen; URLs not captured. Manual pull and confirm.
- "Don't pull over if a stranger flags you; drive somewhere busy and lit" needs a named police source before it goes in the payoff.
- Costco's membership-card policy at the pump: confirm the wording with Costco before Jeff says "send them to the attendant."
- The KCRA "Rossen Reports" AirTag piece (2025): confirm whether it was Jeff's, and what it showed, so the tracker demo is new.

**STORIES CUT — SOURCING PRESERVED**

- Cumming, GA Costco, a 75-year-old asked for directions, $10,000+ charged within two hours (WSB, Dec 2022). Arvada, CO Costco, about $10,000 (Denver7, likely 2023). McKinney, TX Costco "check your bumper" (WFAA, 2022). Strong but old: backups for item 3.
- Fife, WA Costco $10,000 "attorney" con (FOX 13, 2021): the bank-handoff family, a Jul 29 callback.
- Tucson fake-gold sales in northwest-side lots (tucson.com, about late Oct 2026): wouldn't load. If it holds up, it's the freshest peg for item 4.
- Layton, UT: three people tried to sell fake gold to the police chief in a Walmart lot (FOX 13 Utah, likely 2022). A fun line if it can be dated.
- Rockwall, TX: a grandmother's purse taken from her car, cards used within minutes (FOX 4, Aug 2026). It's a Target, so a passing mention at most.

## OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE MEETING

- **The open: San Jose (Costco, 86-year-old, heirloom, no clip confirmed) or Vallejo (Costco, caught on camera, a year old)?** Jeff's note says biggest real result first. I'd open on San Jose's story with Vallejo's video right behind it.
- **The fake-gold beat and the dead list:** keep it as organized fraud with Mettawa's stakeout and $15,800 (if the source holds), or cut it to stay clear of "panhandling hustles"?
- **The tap-to-pay donation story:** when does Jeff's approved standalone air? If before 11/25, one callback line; if after, keep it out of this show entirely.
- **"Jeff, hero of Costco":** how far do we go? I'd use "I love Costco, so I'm going after the people working its parking lots," and ask Costco for comment. Do we want Costco on the record?
- **The demo:** Jim Stickley hides a tracker on a car and both phones alert. Book him for the Friday 11/20 taping?
- **Guest:** Stickley (demo), or a police voice (Portland's Det. Jordan Zaitz worked the Costco crew case; Sacramento Sheriff's PIO)?
- **The old "3 Costco SCAMS" video:** who watches it before the outline?